MODULE 60 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Full Mock, Part Three

Questions 51 to 75 of the mock. Finish the sitting, then total all 75.

PART 3 of 3 QUESTIONS 51-75 SET 6 of 6

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Part three checkpoints

- **Question 58 by minute 20** of this part.
- **Question 67 by minute 40.**
- **Leave five minutes** to answer anything flagged or blank.
- Never leave a question blank. Unanswered scores as incorrect.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> In the last minutes, fill every blank first, then improve answers.

> A trading firm runs dozens of applications built on Apache Kafka client libraries, with Kafka Connect pipelines, on self-managed brokers. It wants to stop managing brokers.
>
> Application code must not change.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Amazon Kinesis Data Streams

B Amazon SQS FIFO queues

C Amazon MSK

D Amazon EventBridge

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Kinesis

Different API; code changes.

B SQS FIFO

Different API and model.

C Amazon MSK

Managed Kafka; same clients and Connect.

D EventBridge

Different API.

THE SIGNAL

Kafka already in use means MSK. Starting fresh with the least to run means Kinesis. Module 13.

A retailer's 400 analysts run the same sales dashboards all day against a 30 TB dataset in S3. Athena queries are slow at peak and costs are rising with each scan.

Dashboards need consistent sub-second to few-second response.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A More Athena workgroups

B Amazon EMR on demand for each query

C Store the data as CSV for faster scans

D Amazon Redshift, loading or querying the curated data, with dashboards pointed at it

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A More workgroups
Same per-scan engine.

B EMR per query
Cluster start-up per query.

C CSV files
Slower and costlier than columnar.

D Amazon Redshift
Built for heavy, concurrent BI.

THE SIGNAL

All-day dashboards for hundreds of users outgrow Athena. Occasional exploration does not need Redshift. Module 13.

A SaaS platform serves 40 enterprise tenants. Some tenants require MFA for every user, others forbid it, and two require different password policies.

All tenants use Amazon Cognito for sign-in.

How should the solutions architect structure Cognito?

A. A user pool per tenant, or per policy group

B. One shared user pool with a tenant attribute

C. One identity pool for all tenants

D. Separate AWS accounts per tenant with IAM users

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the solutions architect structure Cognito?

A **Pool per tenant**
MFA and password policy are set per pool.

B **One shared pool**
Pool-level settings cannot vary by tenant.

C **Identity pool**
Grants AWS credentials; not sign-in policy.

D **IAM users**
Wrong tool for app users.

THE SIGNAL

Settings that live at pool level, such as MFA, cannot vary by attribute. Different rules mean different pools. Module 05.

> A team builds an agent with an open-source framework that assembles its own prompts. It needs relevant passages from a Bedrock knowledge base, but its framework will call the model itself.
>
> The team wants to keep full control of prompting.

Which knowledge base API should the agent call?

A RetrieveAndGenerate

B InvokeModel directly with the whole document set

C Retrieve

D CreateKnowledgeBase

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which knowledge base API should the agent call?

A RetrieveAndGenerate
Generates the answer itself.

B Whole documents
Exceeds context; costly.

C Retrieve
Returns passages; the framework prompts.

D CreateKnowledgeBase
Creates a knowledge base; not a query.

THE SIGNAL

Least code with citations: RetrieveAndGenerate. Custom prompting or an agent framework: Retrieve. Module 07.

A fashion retailer serves product images, CSS and JavaScript to customers worldwide. Most files change weekly and are requested millions of times a day.

It wants lower latency and lower origin load.

What should the solutions architect use?

A AWS Global Accelerator

B Amazon CloudFront

C Route 53 latency-based routing to regional copies

D A larger origin fleet

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Global Accelerator
No caching; every request reaches the origin.

B CloudFront
Caches content at the edge.

C Latency routing
Multiple origins to maintain; no caching.

D Bigger origin
Same latency, more cost.

THE SIGNAL

Cacheable web content means CloudFront. Static IPs, UDP or DNS-free failover mean Global Accelerator. Module 11.

A car manufacturer's assembly-line systems need AWS services and APIs on premises. Production data must not leave the factory, and latency must be in single-digit milliseconds.

The factory has reliable connectivity to its AWS Region.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A An AWS Local Zone near the factory

B AWS Wavelength

C Run everything in the nearest Region

D AWS Outposts racks in the factory

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Local Zone
AWS-owned site; data leaves the factory.

B Wavelength
For 5G networks; off the in-scope list.

C Nearest Region
Data leaves; higher latency.

D Outposts
AWS infrastructure on premises.

THE SIGNAL

On premises is a requirement for Outposts. Low latency to a city alone is a Local Zone. Module 09.

> A company must prevent anyone in member accounts from using AWS Regions other than eu-west-1 and eu-central-1. Global services such as IAM and CloudFront must keep working.
>
> A break-glass role must be exempt.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A IAM policies in every account

B AWS Config rules for each Region

C An SCP denying actions where aws:RequestedRegion is not one of the two, excluding global services and the break-glass role

D Disabling the other Regions in the management account

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A IAM per account
Administrators can change them.

B Config rules
Detects; does not prevent.

C Region-restriction SCP
Org-wide, preventive, with exemptions.

D Disable Regions
Default Regions cannot be disabled.

THE SIGNAL

Deny everywhere, for every identity in member accounts: an SCP with careful exemptions. Module 20.

> A company with 150 accounts wants to find IAM roles nobody has used in 90 days. It also wants permissions within active roles that are never exercised.
>
> It wants findings centrally, with the least custom work.

What should the solutions architect use?

A IAM Access Analyzer unused access analysis for the organisation

B A script reading CloudTrail for every role

C IAM credential reports per account

D GuardDuty

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A **Unused access analyzer**
Unused roles and permissions, org-wide.

B **CloudTrail script**
Custom and costly.

C **Credential reports**
Users only, per account.

D **GuardDuty**
Threat detection.

THE SIGNAL

Find unused roles and permissions across an organisation: Access Analyzer unused access. Module 16.

A payment processor's application performs its own cryptographic operations through the PKCS 11 interface, including key derivation functions that KMS does not offer.

Keys must be held in single-tenant, FIPS-validated HSMs.

What should the solutions architect use?

A AWS KMS with the default key store

B A KMS custom key store

C AWS Secrets Manager

D AWS CloudHSM, used directly by the application

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A KMS default

Multi-tenant; no PKCS 11.

B KMS custom key store

Only KMS operations are available.

C Secrets Manager

Stores secrets; no crypto operations.

D CloudHSM directly

Single-tenant HSM with PKCS 11.

THE SIGNAL

Dedicated HSM plus native AWS service encryption: custom key store. Your own crypto operations: CloudHSM directly. Module 18.

> A company's sensitive S3 buckets must only be accessed from its own VPCs through S3 VPC endpoints. Access from the internet must fail, even with valid credentials.
>
> Some AWS services act on the buckets on the company's behalf.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Security groups on the bucket

B A bucket policy denying requests not coming through the company's VPC endpoints, with an exception for AWS service principals

C S3 Block Public Access only

D IAM policies requiring MFA

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Security groups

Buckets have no security groups.

B Endpoint-restricted bucket policy

A network perimeter on the bucket.

C Block Public Access

Stops public access, not stolen credentials.

D MFA

Does not restrict the network path.

THE SIGNAL

Only from our networks, even with valid credentials: a network perimeter on the resource. Module 17.

A travel agent built on Bedrock AgentCore books flights through an airline's API on behalf of signed-in customers. The airline uses OAuth, and each customer must consent.

Tokens must be stored securely and never handled by the agent's code directly.

What should the solutions architect use?

A Store each customer's tokens in a DynamoDB table

B A shared API key in Secrets Manager

C Amazon Bedrock AgentCore Identity for user-delegated OAuth access

D IAM roles for each customer

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A DynamoDB tokens
Builds a token vault by hand.

B Shared API key
Not on behalf of each customer.

C AgentCore Identity
Consent flows and a managed token vault.

D Role per customer
IAM does not speak the airline's OAuth.

THE SIGNAL

Agents acting for users against third-party OAuth APIs: AgentCore Identity. Module 06.

A RAG assistant over company manuals sometimes gives confident answers that the retrieved passages do not support.

The team wants such answers detected and blocked at runtime.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A. A higher temperature

B. More documents in the knowledge base

C. A denied topic

D. Contextual grounding checks in Amazon Bedrock Guardrails

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Higher temperature

Increases variation.

B More documents

Does not stop unsupported claims.

C Denied topic

Blocks subjects, not unsupported answers.

D Contextual grounding

Blocks answers not supported by the sources.

THE SIGNAL

Answers not supported by retrieved sources: contextual grounding checks. Module 24.

> An internal document classifier on a SageMaker AI real-time endpoint receives a few hundred requests a day, in bursts. It sits idle most of the time.
>
> A few seconds of extra latency on the first request after idle is acceptable.

How should the solutions architect cut cost?

A Use SageMaker Serverless Inference

B Move to a larger instance

C Buy a SageMaker Savings Plan for the endpoint

D Add more instances behind the endpoint

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the solutions architect cut cost?

A **Serverless Inference**
Pays per use; scales to zero when idle.

B **Larger instance**
More idle cost.

C **Savings Plan**
Discounts an instance that sits idle.

D **More instances**
More idle cost.

THE SIGNAL

Idle most of the time, cold starts acceptable: serverless inference. Module 26.

A company runs stateless web services on EKS with fixed node groups of On-Demand instances. Utilisation averages 35 percent.

Services tolerate pods being rescheduled.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Larger node groups

B Reserved Instances for the current nodes

C Karpenter with consolidation enabled, using Spot capacity for these services

D Vertical scaling of each pod

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Larger groups
More idle capacity.

B Reserved Instances
Discounts waste.

C Karpenter, consolidation, Spot
Packs pods, removes idle nodes, cheaper capacity.

D Bigger pods
Does not fix idle nodes.

THE SIGNAL

Poor packing and tolerant pods: Karpenter consolidation with Spot. Modules 03 and 26.

A central networking account runs Transit Gateway, NAT gateways and inspection firewalls used by 50 workload accounts. Its cost appears entirely in one account.

Finance wants that cost shared among the workload accounts' cost centres in proportion to their usage.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Tag the networking resources with every cost centre

B Move networking into every account

C AWS Budgets per account

D AWS Cost Categories with split charge rules allocating the shared networking cost

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Tag with every cost centre

A resource has one value per tag key.

B Duplicate networking

Multiplies cost.

C Budgets

Tracks spend; allocates nothing.

D Cost categories, split charges

Splits shared costs proportionally.

THE SIGNAL

Shared costs allocated to cost centres: cost categories with split charge rules. Module 30.

A portfolio assessment finds an expense-tracking application used by 40 people, which needs a major upgrade. A SaaS product covers its features.

The application has no unique integrations.

Which migration strategy fits this application?

A Rehost it to EC2

B Repurchase: move to the SaaS product and retire the application

C Refactor it to serverless

D Retain it on premises

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which migration strategy fits this application?

A Rehost

Carries the upgrade problem to AWS.

B Repurchase

Replaces it with an existing product.

C Refactor

Effort for a commodity function.

D Retain

Leaves the upgrade problem.

THE SIGNAL

A commodity function a SaaS product already covers: repurchase. Module 32.

> An order database on RDS for PostgreSQL must survive the loss of an Availability Zone with automatic failover and no data loss.
>
> Reporting load is light.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A. A read replica in another Availability Zone

B. Daily snapshots

C. A Multi-AZ deployment

D. A cross-Region read replica

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Read replica
Asynchronous; manual promotion.

B Snapshots
Data loss; slow restore.

C Multi-AZ
Synchronous standby, automatic failover.

D Cross-Region replica
Asynchronous; manual promotion.

THE SIGNAL

High availability with automatic failover: Multi-AZ. Read scaling: replicas. Module 12.

A company rotates its primary Region between us-east-1 and us-west-2 twice a year for operational testing. Its database is an Aurora global database.

The planned rotation must lose no committed data.

What should the solutions architect use?

A Aurora global database switchover

B Aurora global database failover with data loss allowed

C Restore a snapshot in the other Region

D Re-create the cluster with AWS DMS

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Switchover
Planned, synchronised change; no data loss.

B Failover
For outages; may lose recent writes.

C Snapshot restore
Data loss and long downtime.

D DMS rebuild
Slow and needless.

THE SIGNAL

Planned Region change with no data loss: global database switchover. Outage: failover. Module 37.

A company's AWS Backup plan protects EBS volumes and RDS databases in eu-west-1. Its DR policy requires recovery points in eu-central-1 as well.

It wants this without scripts.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A. A Lambda function copying snapshots each night

B. S3 Cross-Region Replication

C. Data Lifecycle Manager in each Region

D. A copy rule in the backup plan to a vault in eu-central-1

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Custom Lambda
Custom code.

B S3 CRR
Not for EBS or RDS backups.

C DLM
EBS only; no cross-Region copy for RDS.

D Backup copy rule
Built-in cross-Region copies.

THE SIGNAL

Recovery points in another Region, no scripts: a cross-Region copy rule in AWS Backup. Module 39.

> Launches across 200 accounts keep failing when teams reach service quotas. Requests to raise quotas are made by hand after the failure.
>
> The platform team wants warnings as usage approaches quotas, and automatic adjustments where possible.

What should the solutions architect use?

A. A weekly Trusted Advisor review

B. Service Quotas automatic quota management, with notifications

C. A Lambda function requesting the maximum for every quota

D. Ask teams to request quotas earlier

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Trusted Advisor
Manual and infrequent.

B Automatic quota management
Alerts near limits; adjusts by usage.

C Request maximums
Removes useful guard rails.

D Earlier requests
Still manual.

THE SIGNAL

Warn near quotas and adjust them by usage: Service Quotas automatic management. Module 48.

> When a CloudWatch alarm reports a full temporary volume on batch servers, an engineer logs in and runs the same cleanup commands every time.
>
> The team wants the fix automated, with each occurrence recorded.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A An SNS email to the team

B Replace the instances every night

C An EventBridge rule on the alarm state change that starts an SSM Automation runbook, and an OpsItem for each occurrence

D A larger volume

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Email

Still manual.

B Nightly replacement

Disruptive; ignores the signal.

C EventBridge to Automation

Fix runs itself, and each event is recorded.

D Larger volume

Delays the problem.

THE SIGNAL

Known fix, run automatically, with a record: alarm to SSM Automation and an OpsItem. Module 46.

> An API's SLO is 99.9 percent availability over a rolling 28 days. Planned maintenance every Sunday for 30 minutes, announced to customers, consumes the error budget.
>
> The customer agreement excludes planned maintenance.

What should the solutions architect do?

A Lower the attainment goal

B Disable SLO alarms on Sundays by hand

C Delete and recreate the SLO each week

D Add a recurring exclusion window for the maintenance period

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect do?

A Lower goal
Weakens the promise all week.

B Manual disable
Budget still consumed.

C Recreate
Loses history.

D Exclusion window
Maintenance excluded from measurement.

THE SIGNAL

Planned maintenance outside the agreement: SLO exclusion windows. Module 46.

A policy assistant on Bedrock answers staff questions from a knowledge base that changes weekly. Staff report vaguer answers over recent months, and there are no labels for production questions.

The team wants an ongoing measure of answer quality.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Score daily samples of production responses from invocation logs with a Bedrock LLM-as-a-judge evaluation, publishing scores to CloudWatch

B A Model Monitor data quality schedule

C An alarm on output token count

D A stricter guardrail

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Judge-scored samples
Measures quality over time without labels.

B Model Monitor
For structured inputs on SageMaker endpoints.

C Token alarm
Length is not quality.

D Stricter guardrail
Blocks content; does not measure.

THE SIGNAL

Generative answers drifting, no labels: evaluate sampled production responses. Module 47.

A web tier of 300 EC2 instances in an Auto Scaling group needs a new AMI. Instances must be replaced gradually, pausing at 10 percent and 50 percent for checks.

If the latency alarm fires, the group must return to the previous launch template automatically.

What should the solutions architect use?

A. Instance refresh with checkpoints at 10 and 50 percent, alarms, and auto rollback

B. Terminate instances in batches by hand

C. CodeDeploy in-place deployment

D. A new Auto Scaling group and a DNS switch

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Instance refresh
Gradual, checkpoints, automatic rollback.

B Manual batches
Manual, no rollback.

C CodeDeploy in place
Deploys code, not AMIs.

D New group, DNS
Not gradual; more to build.

THE SIGNAL

New AMI across an Auto Scaling group, gradual, with rollback: instance refresh. Module 44.

> After a brief throttling event, 3,000 workers retried writes at exactly the same moment, causing two further spikes. Some orders were recorded twice.
>
> The team wants both problems fixed.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Remove retries

B Exponential backoff with jitter, plus idempotent writes using a client token

C Retry every 100 milliseconds

D Raise capacity only

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A No retries

Brief throttles become failures.

B Backoff, jitter, idempotency

Spreads retries; duplicates have no effect.

C Faster fixed retries

Waves arrive sooner.

D More capacity only

Waves and duplicates remain.

THE SIGNAL

Retries arriving in waves, plus duplicates: backoff with jitter, and idempotency. Module 48.

Your total on all 75

TOTAL CORRECT	WHAT IT SUGGESTS
60 or more	Well prepared. Book the exam
52 to 59	Likely passing. Close gaps in your weakest domain
45 to 51	Borderline. Rewatch weak domains, then retake
Below 45	Return to the teaching modules first
Guessed but correct	Count as misses
Over 180 minutes	Practise full sittings with checkpoints

ON THE EXAM

These bands are a guide, not a conversion to 720. Aim well clear before booking.